

Browse through them till you find one which shows your IP address, your subnet address, DNS server addresses etc. This one folder should be linked to your ethernet adaptor.

- Right-click on this interface > Select 'New' > DWORD (32-bit) Value > Name it "TcpAckFrequency" without the quotes. The letter case matters, so take care.
- Right-click on TcpAckFrequency value > Select 'Modify' > Enter "1" as the value and make sure the Hexadecimal base radio button is selected.
- Right-click on the interface > Select 'New' > DWORD (32-bit) Value > Name it "TCPNoDelay" without the quotes.
- Right-click on 'TCP-NoDelay' value > Select 'Modify' >

- Exit Regedit and reboot the operating system.



Get a better ISP

Talk to your ISP and make a list of the game servers that you connect to for most of your games. See if you can find people in your vicinity that have internet connections from different ISPs and ping your game server list using each of their connections. You'll find that some ISPs route traffic better and this results in low pings. Then again, you won't find any one ISP that consistently has lower pings than all other ISPs so go with whichever games you feel are more important and pick an ISP that has low pings for most of those games.



Eschew wireless connections

Wired connections work way better when compared to wireless connections. Especially since objects moving in the path of the wireless connec-



Many VPN servers have lots of dedicated routing servers



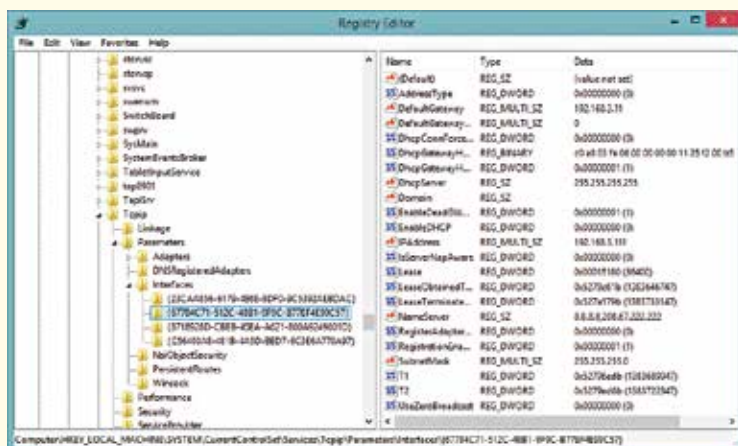
Use a VPN service

Reducing ping is all about changing the route which your packets take in order to get to the game server. Your ISP and all other entities along the route are the only entities that can actually change the routing so it's quite unlikely that an ISP will change its routing for just one consumer or even a hundred. Another way to change your routing will be to invest in a VPN service. VPN services have quite a few servers across many countries that all have optimised routing to their own servers. So these services can get your packets across continents in the most efficient way. But the two points where the packets are actually outside the VPN's network will still affect your latency and you have no control over this.

There are a multitude of VPN services, which offer free and paid services. The difference is that the free services are

limited sessions so you'll have to re-login to your game every 30-60 minutes. The payment plans aren't expensive either – they sell for as low as \$9.99 (approx. ₹600) per month. This includes apps for every platform, which extends the VPN service to all your mobile devices as well. VyperVPN, CactusVPN, IronSocket and AirVPN are such services. You can also pick free software which might, in some cases, turn out to be better than paid services. Each software has a trial period which you can use to test out if they route better or not.

Then there are VPN services specific to games. Take 'PingZapper'. It has a free service that disconnects every 90 minutes but the traffic routing isn't that great on the free service. Payment plans start from \$3.99 (Rs.240) and as soon as you become a premium customer you're switched to better routing. We used this service and found that it shaved off 200ms off Asian servers for *World of Tanks* and *Dota 2*. 



A few registry entries is all it takes

Enter "1" as the value and make sure the Hexadecimal base radio button is selected.

- Verify that both values show up in the adapter's property list with "0x00000001" being the value.

tion do affect the travel time of packets. Switch to using the ethernet cable over your Wi-Fi connection whenever you're gaming. For all other activities including video calls, you don't have to worry since media heavy activities are transmitted via UDP as compared to TCP.